

bring all of them into a single platform, which is nearly impossible.

According to CISCO, these issues related to interoperability have resulted in 75% project failures. Moreover, statistics suggest that only one out of six organisations are actually benefiting from implementation of the IoT solutions.

These statistics are very scary, and one of the major reasons for this scenario is perception. A developer from an IT background may claim that 35% of his projects have succeeded, keeping in mind the specifications and features. But from a user's perspective, only 15% of people say that IoT has helped them. These statistics need to change, and startups must try to take these numbers from 15% to 50% in the next two years, and 80 to 85% in the next 4-5 years.

As said, one of the biggest reasons for failure of IoT solutions is perception. IoT today is like the proverbial elephant that is being looked at by some blind men in their own different ways. Some think IoT is a network of interconnected sensors, some consider it to be just AI and analytics, and some talk about connectivity or applications only.

It is critical to understand that an IoT solution is a complete ecosystem from hardware to connectivity. Imagining IoT products being a complete package, with each aspect given equal importance, is crucial. It is important that we come out of this blind man syndrome and begin our journey in IoT properly.

The approach

For building a helpful IoT solution, one should start thinking of a domain or a vertical to solve use cases. There are many use cases available to start building an IoT platform. The IoT platform we are talking about here is an end-to-end service, right from the hardware to the cloud applications. Installations and after-sales services must be considered in the end-to-end service.

Once the solution is built for the use-case targeted, one can localise it for local needs. It is important to start with a small set of industries, which can be catered to by that solution, and then start building on it. There is no need to build something that is targeted for every use-case as the economics may not favour it.

The operating expense, or opex, is one of the key aspects in launching a solution. It is critical to start generating revenue within 6-8 months of launching the product. That is where the quick solutions for these applications would be helpful.

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